

Podium Operations Manual

The self-serve guide to Legend of Toys' people & performance system: profiles, the org chart, observations, wins, 1:1s, OKRs, appraisals and the people-data that stays private by design.

EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

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PART 1

Getting Started

What Podium is, how to sign in, find your way around, and exactly what your access lets you see.

Welcome to Podium

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Podium is the Legend of Toys people & performance system: one place for who works here, how the company is structured, the good work people do through the year, and the twice-yearly appraisal. It is the most private system we run, so almost everything you see is scoped tightly to you, your team and your role. This manual is your self-serve guide to every screen in it.

What Podium holds

Podium brings together things that used to live in spreadsheets, chat threads and people's memories:

AREA	WHAT IT COVERS
People	Every person's profile: contact details, employment, documents and (for HR) compensation history. A headcount dashboard and a searchable directory.
Org chart	The live reporting structure, who reports to whom, drawn from each person's manager. Snapshots let you keep a picture of how the org looked on a given date.
Performance	Continuous record-keeping through the year: observations a manager logs, wins people record about themselves, and 1:1 meeting notes.
Appraisals	The twice-yearly review: a self-review, a manager review, an HR calibration, the final rating shared with you, and the increment that follows.
Org design	The registry of job roles (with their job descriptions and KPIs) and the department structure everything else hangs off.

Who it is for

Everyone at Legend of Toys uses Podium, but most people use only a small corner of it:

- **Everyone** can see their own profile, record their own wins, and take part in their own appraisal.
- **Managers** additionally see their team, log observations and 1:1s, and review their team's appraisals.
- **HR and admins** run the whole thing: people, departments, roles, documents, appraisal cycles and settings.

① PRIVACY IS THE WHOLE POINT

Unlike our other systems, Podium does **not** show everything to everyone. What you can see depends on who you are, who reports to you, and the access your account has been given. The next two chapters explain exactly how that works, because it shapes every screen in this manual.

How to use this manual

Each chapter covers one screen and follows the same shape: what it is for, how to read it, and what to do. Jump to the screen you are on using the Contents page or your PDF reader's bookmarks. Chapters are tagged with the access tiers that use them:

EMPLOYEE

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Callout boxes

✓ TIP

A faster or smarter way to do something.

⚠ WATCH OUT

A common mistake or something easy to misread.

🚫 IMPORTANT

Something that affects someone's privacy, their pay or an official record: get it right.

Signing In & Getting Around

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Podium opens with one click using your work Google account, and everything is reachable from a short sidebar grouped by what it does. This chapter covers signing in and finding your way around. What appears in your sidebar depends on your access, so two people can see different menus.

Signing in

Open `podium.legendoftoys.com` and sign in with your `@legendoftoys.com` Google account. Personal accounts are refused; if sign-in bounces you back, sign out of any personal Google account first or use a fresh browser profile. There is no separate Podium password: your Google login is your login.

① FIRST TIME IN?

If you sign in and Podium says you don't have an employee profile linked yet, that's normal for a brand-new joiner: ask HR to link your profile to your login. Until then you can sign in but there's nothing personal to show you.

The menu

The sidebar is grouped. You only see the groups and items your access allows:

GROUP	WHAT LIVES HERE	WHO SEES IT
PEOPLE	Dashboard, Directory, Org Chart, New Person.	Managers, HR and admins. (New Person is HR/admin only.)
PERFORMANCE	My Performance, Team, Appraisals.	My Performance is for everyone; Team for managers; Appraisals for HR/admin.
ORG DESIGN	Roles & KPIs, Departments.	Managers, HR and admins.
SYSTEM MANUAL	This manual, in the app.	Everyone.
ADMIN	Roles & Permissions, Users, Settings.	Admins only.

✓ IF YOUR SIDEBAR IS SHORT, THAT'S EXPECTED

A self-serve employee with no special access sees only **My Performance**, and Podium opens straight to it. That's by design, not a bug: you have full access to your own record and nothing about anyone else. The moment HR gives you a wider role, or someone starts reporting to you, the extra menus appear.

Getting around

Most list screens (the Directory, the appraisal grid) have a search box and clickable rows: click any row to open it. The Directory and other lists also support the arrow keys with Enter to open the highlighted row. The top of a detail screen has a **Back** button that returns you to where you came from.

Names are links almost everywhere: a person's name in the org chart, on a team feed card, or in an appraisal grid takes you to their profile (subject to what you're allowed to see).

Roles & What You Can See



Podium decides what you can see from two separate things: your **access tier** (set by an admin) and your **place in the org chart** (who reports to you). This chapter explains both in plain terms, because together they shape every screen in the rest of this manual.

The four access tiers

	The default for everyone. You can see your own profile in full, record and edit your own wins, see observations and 1:1 notes that have been shared with you, and take part in your own appraisal. You see nothing about anyone else. This is what you get with no special role assigned, and it is a real, full level of access to <i>your</i> data, not a locked-out state.
	Anyone with people reporting to them. On top of the employee tier, you see the full profiles of everyone in your reporting line (your direct reports and the people under them), log observations and 1:1s for them, and review their appraisals. You do not get this from a role: Podium works it out from the org chart, so the day someone starts reporting to you, you become their manager in Podium automatically.
	The People team. Sees everyone's full profile, adds and edits people, manages departments, job roles and documents, captures org snapshots, and runs appraisal cycles. HR sees the most sensitive fields (bank details, ID proofs, PAN) that even a person's manager cannot.
	Full control. Everything HR can do, plus Podium's own Roles & Permissions, assigning people to roles, and system settings (including the salary vault).

① A SEPARATE LEVEL FOR PAY

Seeing **compensation** (increments, bonuses and salary bands) is a distinct permission that an admin grants on its own. So you can be HR and manage people without seeing pay, or be given pay access without being a full admin. Wherever this manual says “if you have compensation access,” that is the permission it means.

Who sees what

AREA	EMPLOYEE	MANAGER	HR	ADMIN
Your own profile & wins, your own appraisal	•	•	•	•
Directory, org chart, dashboard		•	•	•
Full profile of your reporting line; log observations & 1:1s for them		•	•	•
Full profile of <i>everyone</i> ; add/edit people; departments & roles; documents			•	•
Run appraisal cycles, calibrate, share results			•	•
Bank details, ID proofs, PAN	own		•	•
Compensation (increments, bonuses, salary bands)			only with compensation access	
Roles & Permissions, Users, Settings				•

🚫 WHAT A MANAGER CANNOT SEE

Being someone's manager lets you see their full profile, but **not** their bank details, ID proofs or PAN, and not their pay. Those stay with HR and the person themselves. This is deliberate: management visibility is not the same as HR visibility.

How your access is set

Your access comes from a **Podium role** an admin assigns to your account (on the Users screen). Podium runs its own roles, separate from every other LOT system, so being made HR in Podium does not change your access in Garage, Redline or anywhere else. If you cannot do something you believe you should, an admin needs to adjust your Podium role; your manager visibility, separately, follows the org chart.

⚠️ TWO DIFFERENT THINGS, OFTEN CONFUSED

"Manager" in Podium is about the org chart (who reports to you), and it drives what profiles you can open. A "role" like HR or Admin is a separate access tier an admin grants. You can be a manager with no special role at all, and still see your team, because that visibility comes from the org chart, not the role.

PART 2

People

The headcount dashboard, the directory, individual profiles, the org chart and adding someone new.

Dashboard

/dashboard

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The Dashboard is Podium's home screen for anyone with people access: a quick read on the size and shape of the company, who has just joined, and whose anniversary or birthday is coming up. It is a glance, not a place to change anything.

WHAT IT'S FOR A snapshot of headcount and the month ahead.	READ OR ACT? Read-only.	WHO MANAGER HR ADMIN	COVERS The whole company.
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The headline tiles

A strip of tiles across the top counts people by their current status:

TILE	WHAT IT COUNTS
Headcount	Everyone currently active. This is the number people usually mean by "how many are we?"
Departments	How many departments exist.
On Leave	People marked as on leave.
Notice	People serving notice.
Exited	People who have left. They stay in Podium for the record; they just don't count in headcount.

The cards

Below the tiles, five cards break the numbers down and surface the near future:

By Department	Each department with its headcount, largest first. A fast read on where the people are.
By Employment Type	The active team split into full-time, intern, contract and so on.

Recent Joiners	The six newest active people, with their title and how long they've been here. Click any name to open their profile.
Upcoming Work Anniversaries	Anyone whose joining date anniversary falls in the next 30 days, with how many days away it is.
Upcoming Birthdays	The same, for birthdays in the next 30 days. Empty if nobody has one coming up.

① WHY A CARD MIGHT BE EMPTY

The anniversary and birthday cards rely on each person having a joining date and a date of birth on file. If a card says "None in the next 30 days," it may genuinely be quiet, or it may mean those dates are missing on some profiles. The fix is to fill them in on the Profile screen.

✓ TIP

The anniversary and birthday cards are the easiest way to never miss a moment that matters to someone. A quick scan on a Monday morning sets up the week's shout-outs.

Directory

/people

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The Directory is the searchable list of everyone at Legend of Toys. It is where you look someone up, filter by team or status, and open a profile. For HR it is also the door to adding a new person and to pulling the latest joiners and leavers from Google.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	COVERS
Finding and opening people.	Read; HR can add & sync.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	Everyone, filterable.

Reading the list

Each row shows the person's **code** (their EMP number, in yellow), **name** (with a preferred name in brackets if they have one), **title**, **department**, **manager** and a **status** badge. Click any row, or use the arrow keys and Enter, to open that person's profile.

Narrowing it down

Two controls sit above the list:

- **Status tabs:** Active (the default), On Leave, Notice, Exited, or All. Most of the time Active is what you want; switch to Exited or All to find someone who has left.
- **Search and department:** the search box matches name, code, title or email; the dropdown filters to one department. Use them together to zero in.

HR actions

If you're HR or an admin, two buttons appear top-right:

- 1 **New Person** opens the form to create a profile from scratch. See the *New Person* chapter.
- 2 **Sync from Google** pulls the company's Google Workspace directory and shows you who's new and who looks like they've left, for you to review before anything is written. See the callout below.

① SYNC FROM GOOGLE, IN PLAIN TERMS

The sync compares Podium against the Google directory and proposes changes: new joiners to add and people who've disappeared from Google (possible leavers). **Nothing is saved until you confirm.** You tick who to bring in and who to mark as exited; shared mailboxes and accounts you've told it to ignore are left out. It never overwrites edits you've made by hand and never guesses a reporting line, so a new joiner still needs their manager set afterwards.

⚠ A BLANK DIRECTORY ISN'T BROKEN

If you have only self-serve access, you won't have the Directory at all; that's the access tier working as intended (see *Roles & What You Can See*). If you can open it but a filter returns nothing, check the status tab: someone you expect to find may have left and now sits under Exited.

A Person's Profile

</people/detail>

EMPLOYEEMANAGERHRADMIN

A person's profile is the single page that gathers everything Podium knows about them: their employment and personal details, their team, documents, compensation history, and the running record of their performance. How much of it you see depends entirely on who you are to that person, so this is the screen where Podium's privacy rules are most visible.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	TABS
One person, everything about them.	Read; HR edits; managers log performance.	EMPLOYEEMANAGERHRADMIN	Profile · Observations · Wins · 1:1s

Full view vs limited view

At the top, under the person's name, you may see a yellow banner reading *"Limited view, full profile is visible to HR, the person, and their managers."* That tells you you're looking at the public-facing subset (essentially their role and where they sit), not the whole profile. You get the **full** view only when the person is you, when you're in their management chain, or when you're HR or an admin.

 WHAT STAYS HIDDEN, EVEN IN THE FULL VIEW

A manager seeing a report's full profile still does **not** see their bank details, ID proofs or PAN; those appear only for HR, an admin, and the person themselves. Compensation is hidden too, unless you specifically have compensation access. Visibility is not all-or-nothing: the most sensitive fields are walled off separately.

The Profile tab

The profile is a set of cards. Which ones appear depends on your view:

CARD	WHAT'S ON IT	SHOWN TO
Employment	Job role, manager, employment type, legal entity, location, joining date and tenure. The full view adds probation and confirmation dates, and exit details if they've left.	Everyone (more in the full view).
Personal	Work and personal email, phone, date of birth, gender, blood group, emergency contact, and PAN.	Full view only. PAN shows only to HR/admin and the person.

CARD	WHAT'S ON IT	SHOWN TO
Team	The people who report to this person. Click a name to jump to their profile.	Anyone, if they have reports.
Documents	Files on record (offer letters, ID, and so on), each downloadable.	Full view only.
Compensation	Increment and bonus history.	Compensation access only.

Editing (HR only)

If you're HR or an admin, an **Edit** button sits top-right. It opens the same form used to add a person (see *New Person* for the field-by-field guide). Note the employee code can never be changed; it is the person's permanent ID.

Documents

Documents are held privately: clicking **Download** fetches the file through a short-lived secure link, so the file is never sitting on a public address. HR and admins can upload new documents and delete existing ones; everyone else with the full view can only download.

① THE SALARY VAULT

On the Compensation card you'll often see a note that the **salary vault is disabled**. While it's off, Podium records only **increment percentages and one-time bonus amounts**, never absolute salary figures. "Current CTC" will read "(vault off)." This is intentional until the extra security layer is in place; see the *Settings* chapter.

The performance tabs

Three further tabs turn the profile into the person's performance record. What you can do on them depends on whether you manage this person.

Observations

Short notes a manager logs about the person's work through the year, each with a **tone** (Positive, Neutral or Constructive), a date, optional tags, and a **visibility** setting that decides who can read it:

VISIBILITY	WHO CAN READ IT
Private	Only the author and HR. The person it's about <i>never</i> sees it.
Shared with managers	The author, the person's manager chain, and HR. Still not the person.
Shared with person	The above, plus the person themselves.

Managers (and HR) log observations; you can't write one about yourself. On your own profile, or via My Performance, you see only the observations explicitly shared with you.

Wins

Accomplishments the person records about **themselves**: a title, optional detail, a date and tags. Wins are self-authored, so the place you add your own is your *My Performance* page; here you're viewing someone's wins as part of their record.

1:1s

Notes from one-to-one meetings, logged by the manager. Each has **shared notes** the report can see, an optional set of **action items** (tickable checkboxes), and **private notes** for the manager alone.

PRIVATE 1:1 NOTES ARE TRULY PRIVATE

The private-notes box on a 1:1 is visible only to the manager who wrote it and to HR. The report, and even skip-level managers, never see it; they see "Private manager notes hidden" instead. Use it freely for candid manager-only context, and equally, never write something in *shared* notes that you only meant for yourself.

Org Chart

/org

MANAGER

HR

ADMIN

The Org Chart draws the company's reporting structure as a tree: who reports to whom, all the way up to the founders. It is built automatically from each person's manager, so it is always as current as the profiles behind it. You can also keep dated snapshots of how the org looked at a point in time.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SOURCE
Seeing the reporting structure.	Read; HR captures snapshots.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	Each person's manager.

Reading the chart

Each person is a node; lines connect a manager to their reports. The founders sit at the top with no manager. Click any node to open that person's profile (when you're viewing the live chart).

The toolbar

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Expand all / Collapse to founders	Open the whole tree, or fold it back to just the top of the company.
Horizontal / Vertical layout	Switch between the classic top-down chart and a compact left-to-right indented tree that's easier to scan for a wide org.
People count	A live total, with a figure that excludes the founders so you can see team size at a glance.
Zoom & pan	Drag to move around and zoom to fit large charts on screen.

Snapshots

The dropdown at the top lets you switch between **Live (current)** and any saved snapshot. A snapshot is a frozen picture of the whole tree on the day it was captured, useful for "how were we structured at the last appraisal?" or for a board pack.

- 1

To take one (HR/admin), click **Capture snapshot**, give it a label, and confirm. It's saved with today's date.

2

To view one, pick it from the dropdown. The header shows a “snapshot” tag so you know you're not looking at the live chart.

⚠ SNAPSOTS ARE READ-ONLY HISTORY

While you're viewing a snapshot, clicking a node won't open a profile; it's a historical record, not the live org. Switch back to **Live (current)** to navigate to people again. A snapshot also never changes after capture, so it stays a faithful record even as the live org moves on.

✓ IF SOMEONE'S IN THE WRONG PLACE

The chart is only ever as right as the profiles. If a person hangs under the wrong manager, the fix isn't here; it's on their profile, where HR sets their manager. Change it there and the chart redraws itself.

New Person

/people/new

HR

ADMIN

New Person is the form HR uses to add someone to Podium. It's the same form you reach by clicking Edit on an existing profile, so once you know it you know both. It's grouped into sections so you can fill in what you have now and come back for the rest.

WHAT IT'S FOR Adding a person (or editing one).	READ OR ACT? Act: creates a profile.	WHO HR ADMIN	REQUIRED Full name. Everything else optional.
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The sections

Identity	Full name (the only required field), preferred name, work and personal email, phone, date of birth, gender, blood group, PAN and a photo URL. Date of birth feeds the birthday reminders on the Dashboard.
Role & Reporting	Job title, department, job role (from the registry), manager, employment type, legal entity and work location. The manager you pick here is what places the person on the org chart.
Lifecycle	Joining date, probation end, confirmation date and status. Setting the status to Exited reveals an exit date and reason. Joining date feeds tenure and work-anniversary reminders.
Emergency Contact	A name and phone for emergencies.

Adding someone

- 1 **Enter at least the full name.** You can save with just that and enrich the profile later.
- 2 **Fill in role and reporting.** Setting the manager now means the person appears on the org chart straight away.
- 3 **Add lifecycle dates.** The joining date is worth getting in early; tenure, anniversaries and appraisal eligibility all hang off it.
- 4 **Click Create person.** Podium assigns a permanent employee code (an EMP number) automatically; you don't set it and it can never be changed.

① LOGINS ARE LINKED SEPARATELY

Creating a profile does not, by itself, give someone a Podium login. A person can have a full profile, an org-chart spot, documents and compensation history without ever signing in; that's how we keep records for floor and contract staff who don't have a company Google account. Self-serve sign-in only works once their profile is linked to their @legendoftoys.com account, which usually happens automatically when you sync from Google or link them by email.

✓ ALREADY IN GOOGLE? SYNC INSTEAD

If the new joiner already has a company Google account, the fastest route is **Sync from Google** on the Directory: it proposes them as a new joiner with their department and login pre-matched, so you confirm rather than retype. Use this form for people who aren't in Google, or to fill in the details sync can't know.

PART 3

Performance

Your own performance page, the team feed, and the twice-yearly appraisal cycle from self-review to acknowledgement.

My Performance

/me

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My Performance is your own corner of Podium: the wins you've recorded, the observations and 1:1 notes that have been shared with you, the open action items from your meetings, and your live appraisal. Everyone has this page, even with no other access, and it always shows only your own data.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCOPE
Your record, in one place.	Act: record your own wins; take part in your appraisal.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	Always just you.

The Appraisals block

When there's a live appraisal cycle that involves you, a yellow **Appraisals** block sits at the top. It's your one-click way in, and it's how you take part without needing any special menu:

- Your own appraisal:** "start your self-review," "self-review submitted (editable)," or "your result is ready" once HR shares it. Click through to the appraisal screen.
- Reviews you owe:** if you manage people, anyone of yours waiting on your manager review appears here too.

If there's no active cycle, the block simply isn't shown. The full walkthrough is in *Filling In an Appraisal*.

Open action items

If your 1:1s have left you with action items that aren't done yet, they're gathered into a banner near the top, each tagged with the meeting it came from. It's a running to-do list pulled straight from your check-ins, so nothing quietly slips.

The three tabs

My Wins	Accomplishments you record about yourself. Click Add win , give it a title (and optional detail, a date and tags), and save. These are yours to add and edit, and they're the raw material for your self-review at appraisal time.

Shared With Me	Observations your managers (or HR) have explicitly chosen to share with you. You only ever see observations on this tier; the private and managers-only ones never appear here.
My 1:1s	Your one-to-one notes: the shared notes your manager wrote and the action items, which you can read. You can't edit a 1:1 (your manager owns it), and the manager-only private notes never show.

✓ RECORD WINS AS THEY HAPPEN

The best time to log a win is right after it lands, not the night before your self-review. A steady trickle through the year makes the appraisal write-up almost automatic, and gives your manager real examples to draw on.

① WHY YOU CAN'T SEE EVERY NOTE ABOUT YOU

"Shared With Me" shows only what was deliberately shared. Managers also keep constructive or work-in-progress observations at a more private setting while they're still forming a view. That's by design (see the Profile chapter for the visibility tiers); it isn't that something is being hidden from you unfairly, it's that not every working note is meant to be a finished message.

OKRs

/okrs

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OKRs are how Podium tracks what we're trying to achieve each half-year and how far we've got. An **Objective** is a short, ambitious statement of intent; under it sit two to five **Key Results** — measurable checks that tell you whether the objective actually happened. They cascade from the company down to departments and individuals, run on the same twice-yearly rhythm as appraisals, and score themselves from your check-ins.

WHAT IT'S FOR Set goals, track progress, grade the outcome.	CADENCE Two cycles a year (Apr & Oct), aligned to appraisals.	WHO EMPLOYEEMANAGER HRAADMIN	SCOPE Company & dept goals are open; individual goals stay within the reporting line.
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The three levels

Company	The handful of goals the whole business is pushing on this cycle. Set by HR/leadership. Everyone can see them.
Department	A team's goals, ideally aligned up to a company objective. Set by HR or the department head. Everyone can see them.
Individual	Your own goals for the cycle, ideally aligned up to a department or company objective. You (or your manager) set them. Only you, your managers up the chain, and HR can see them — not your peers.

Key results & scoring

Each key result has a **start**, a **target**, and a live **current** value — or, for a yes/no result, a simple *milestone*. Its score is how far you've moved from start to target, capped between 0% and 100%. The objective's overall progress is the weighted average of its key results.

Two numbers matter: the **auto progress** (computed continuously from your check-ins) and, at the end, the **final grade** — a score you set yourself when the cycle moves to scoring, alongside a short reflection. The auto number is shown next to it for reference. Grading is deliberately a judgment call, not just the arithmetic.

Checking in

Open any objective and, on each key result, click **Check in**: enter the new current value, pick a confidence (*On track / At risk / Off track*), and add an optional note on what moved. Every check-in is kept as history, and the progress bar updates immediately.

✓ A WEEKLY RHYTHM BEATS A SCRAMBLE

Update your key results little and often. A result that hasn't been touched in a fortnight gets a **Needs check-in** flag on your *My Performance* page and on the cycle overview — a gentle nudge, not a telling-off.

Where OKRs live

OKRs	The overview: pick a cycle, then browse company, department and individual objectives with their progress. Click any objective to open it.
My Performance	Your <i>My OKRs</i> block — your objectives with quick check-in, a button to add a new objective, and the company/department goals surfaced to you.
Team	Managers see their reports' objectives and progress, and can drill into any of them.

The cycle, start to finish (HR)

HR runs cycles from **OKRs** → **Manage cycles**. A cycle moves through four states:

- **Draft** — HR is building it and seeding company & department objectives; nobody else sees it yet.
- **Active** — the working window. People add key results and check in; progress is live.
- **Scoring** — end of cycle. Owners set the final grade and a reflection on each objective.
- **Closed** — read-only archive.

OKRs & appraisals

Because a cycle is anchored to an appraisal date, the individual objectives for that period show up — read-only — on the appraisal screen, so the reviewer has the goals in front of them. **They are context only and never change the rating or the increment.**

Team

/team

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Team is a manager's feed of recent activity across everyone who reports to them, directly or further down the line. It's where you keep an eye on your people's wins and observations, and where you quickly log a new observation without hunting through profiles.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCOPE
Your team's recent performance activity.	Read; log observations inline.	MANAGER ADMIN	Your whole reporting line.

Who shows up here

The feed covers your reporting chain: your direct reports and the people under them. If you don't manage anyone yet, the page says so; people appear here the moment they're set to report to you (on their profile).

Reading the feed

Each card is one piece of activity, newest first, tagged by type:

TYPE	WHAT IT SHOWS
Observation	A note logged about the person, with its tone (Positive, Neutral, Constructive).
Win	An accomplishment the person recorded about themselves.
1:1	A one-to-one's shared notes. If it's a 1:1 you're not party to, it shows as "Private 1:1" without the contents.

Click a card to jump to that person's profile. Two dropdowns at the top filter the feed: by **type** (just observations, just wins, just 1:1s) and by **person**.

Logging an observation

- 1

Use the yellow "Log observation for..." dropdown and pick the person.
- 2

Write what you observed and set its tone and its visibility (see the callout). Add a date and tags if useful.

3

Save. It joins their record on their profile and your feed. Close the panel with the x when you're done.

🔴 CHOOSE THE VISIBILITY DELIBERATELY

Every observation has a visibility, and it decides who ever reads it: **Private** (you and HR only), **Shared with managers** (you, the chain above the person, and HR), or **Shared with person** (also the person themselves). The person never sees the first two. Pick before you save: get it right at the moment of writing rather than relying on fixing it later.

✓ LITTLE AND OFTEN BEATS A YEAR-END SCRAMBLE

A few honest observations spread through the period make calibration and the appraisal write-up far easier, and fairer, than trying to remember everything in one sitting. The inline logger is built so you can do it in the flow of a normal week.

Appraisals (HR)

/appraisals HR ADMIN

Appraisals is where HR runs the twice-yearly review from start to finish: create a cycle, choose who's in it, watch progress as self-reviews and manager reviews come in, calibrate the final ratings, and share results. This chapter covers the HR view; the form everyone fills in is covered in *Filling In an Appraisal*.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	CADENCE
Running appraisal cycles.	Act: create, enroll, calibrate, share.	HR ADMIN	Twice a year: 1 Apr & 1 Oct.

How a cycle works

Cycles are anchored to an **appraisal date**, either 1 April or 1 October. That date is also when any increment takes effect. Everything else is worked out from it: the six-month review window, and the eligibility cut-off (three months before the anchor). A cycle moves through four states:

STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS
Draft	Being set up. Enroll people here. No reviews accepted yet.
Active	Open for self-reviews and manager reviews.
Calibration	Reviews locked; HR sets the final ratings and shares results.
Closed	Done and read-only.

Creating and enrolling

- 1 New cycle.** Pick the appraisal date (1 Apr / 1 Oct) and an optional name like "H2 2026." The window and cut-off fill in themselves.
- 2 Enroll people.** Open enrollment to see everyone with their eligibility worked out for you. **Eligible** means they joined before the cut-off; borderline and missing-join-date cases are flagged for your judgement. Tick who's in and enroll them.
- 3 Activate.** Move the cycle to Active to open reviews. People now see their self-review on My Performance, and managers see the reviews they owe.

① **CATCH-UP PERIODS ARE AUTOMATIC**

Each person's review window runs from their *last* appraisal (or their joining date if it's their first) up to the anchor. So someone who joined mid-period, or missed a cycle, automatically gets a longer first window rather than being short-changed. Their increment is pro-rated to match.

The cycle dashboard

Opening a cycle shows progress tiles, **Enrolled**, **Self done**, **Mgr done**, **Finalized**, **Shared**, **Acknowledged** and a **PIP** count, so you can see at a glance where the cohort is. Below them is the calibration grid: one row per person showing their self rating, their manager's rating, the final rating, an HR-only note, and a suggested increment percentage.

Calibrating and sharing

- 1 **Move the cycle to Calibration** when reviews are in. This locks further editing of the reviews.
- 2 **Set each final rating** in the grid (1–5) and add an optional calibration note. The note is HR-internal and never shown to the employee. Click Finalize.
- 3 **Share results.** Use **Share all finalized** to release every finalized result at once, or share one at a time from a person's appraisal. Only then can the employee see their rating.
- 4 **Close the cycle** when everyone's done.

🔒 **NOTHING REACHES THE EMPLOYEE UNTIL YOU SHARE**

Self-ratings, manager ratings, your calibration note and the final rating all stay hidden from the employee until the moment you share. The employee never sees the manager's raw rating or your note, only the final rating and the manager's written feedback. Share deliberately, and only once a result is genuinely finalized.

⚠️ **A LOW FINAL RATING TRIGGERS A PIP**

If a final rating falls at or below the threshold (2 by default), the appraisal is flagged as a Performance Improvement Plan and counted on the PIP tile. That's a deliberate, visible outcome, so set final ratings with care.

Filling In an Appraisal

/appraisals/detail

EMPLOYEE

MANAGER

HR

ADMIN

This is the single appraisal screen everyone uses, but it shows you a different face depending on who you are to it: the person being appraised, their manager, or HR. You reach it from the link on My Performance (for your own or one you owe) or from the cycle grid (for HR). It shows you exactly the part you need to fill in, and hides the rest until it's meant to be seen.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCALE
One person's appraisal, end to end.	Act: write, rate, calibrate, acknowledge.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	1–5 plus three written prompts.

The flow, in order

An appraisal moves through clear stages, each unlocking the next: **self-review** → **manager review** → **HR calibration** → **shared with you** → **acknowledged**. You only ever act on the stage that's yours.

If it's your appraisal

EMPLOYEE

- 1 Give yourself an overall rating from 1 to 5, using the rating buttons.
- 2 Answer the three prompts in writing: what went well, what could have gone better, and your focus for the next period.
- 3 Rate your KPIs if your role has them (optional).
- 4 Submit. You can keep editing while the cycle is open; submitting also lets your manager start their review.

Once HR shares the result, this screen shows **Your result**: your final rating, your manager's written feedback, and any increment. You can optionally **acknowledge** it with a note, and open a printable letter.

If you're the manager

MANAGER

You see the person's submitted self-review first, then your own form: an overall rating, the same three prompts, and optional per-KPI ratings. Submit when ready; like the self-review, it stays editable while the cycle is open. You do not set the final rating, that's HR's calibration step, and you won't see the final number until it's finalized.

① THE THREE PROMPTS

Every review, self and manager, answers the same three questions: **what went well**, **what could have gone better**, and the **focus for the next period**. Keeping the prompts identical on both sides makes the two views easy to compare side by side at calibration.

If you're HR HR

You see both reviews in full, then the **calibration** panel:

- 1 **Set the final rating** (1–5) and an optional calibration note. The note is HR-internal and never shown to the employee. Click Finalize.
- 2 **Record the increment** if you have compensation access: an increment percentage and/or a one-time bonus. The effective date defaults to the cycle's anchor, and the suggested percentage comes from the rating band.
- 3 **Share with the employee**. Until you do, they see nothing.
- 4 **Print the letters**. An appraisal letter, and an increment letter where there's a revision, open as clean printable pages you can save as PDF.

🔒 THE CALIBRATION NOTE STAYS WITH HR

The calibration note is for HR's own record only. It is never shown to the employee or the manager, even after sharing. Use it for context behind a decision; never put anything in it you'd be uncomfortable keeping internal.

① INCREMENTS WHILE THE VAULT IS OFF

With the salary vault disabled (the current default), an increment records the **percentage and any bonus amount**, not an absolute salary. The increment letter states the revision in those terms. Absolute figures only come into play once the vault is switched on, after the extra security layer is live (see *Settings*).

Analytics

/analytics

HR

ADMIN

Analytics is the numbers view of Podium: how the team is growing, what it costs, and how performance is trending. Everything on this page is a total or an average: it never shows any individual person’s pay or rating.

WHAT IT’S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	EXTRA GATE
Org, cost & performance trends.	Read-only.	HRADMIN	Payroll Cost: salary allow-list only.

The three sections

SECTION	WHAT IT SHOWS
Org & Headcount	Headcount by department and type, joiners vs exits by month, how long people have been here, and the attrition rate.
Payroll Cost	Total annual CTC and the monthly cost it implies, cost by department, salary spread, and a plan-vs-actuals trend that fills in as real payouts are recorded. Only visible to the salary allow-list.
Performance	Rating spread and participation for recent appraisal cycles, PIP count, and how actively observations, wins and 1:1s are being logged.

① AGGREGATES ONLY

The Payroll Cost section is department totals and averages. To see a specific person’s pay you still go to their profile, and that stays limited to the salary allow-list, with every view logged.

① EMPTY CHARTS ARE NORMAL AT FIRST

Cycle charts appear after the first appraisal cycle runs, and the “actuals” series fills in as payouts are recorded (automatically once the payroll connector is live). An empty chart means no data yet, not a fault.

PART 4

Org Design

The role and KPI registry and the department structure that the org chart and appraisals are built on.

Roles & KPIS

/roles

MANAGER

HR

ADMIN

Roles & KPIS is the registry of job roles at Legend of Toys: each role's title, level, job description, the responsibilities it carries, the KPIS it's measured on, and (for those with compensation access) its salary band. People are then assigned to a role on their profile, and the role's KPIS flow into their appraisal.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	FEEDS
Defining job roles and their KPIS.	Read; HR edits; bands need comp access.	MANAGER ADMIN	Profiles & appraisal KPIS.

The role list

The main screen lists every role with its title, code, level, department, KPI count and (if you have compensation access) the mid-point of its salary band. A locked padlock in the band column means the bands exist but you don't have access to see them. Click a row to open the role.

A role's detail

Each role has two halves:

Job Definition	Title, code, level, department, a short summary, the full job description, and a list of responsibilities (one per line). HR edits these; everyone else reads them.
KPIS	The measures this role is judged on. Each KPI has a name, description, a type (quantitative or qualitative), a target and a weight. These are what appear, per person, in the appraisal.
Salary band	Minimum, mid and maximum for the role. Visible and editable only with compensation access; hidden behind a padlock for everyone else.
People in this role	Everyone currently assigned to the role, each a link to their profile.

Creating and editing (HR)

- 1 **New Role** on the list: enter a title (and optional code and level) to create it, then you land on its detail to flesh it out.
- 2 **Fill in the definition** and click **Save definition**. Mark a role **inactive** rather than deleting it when it's no longer in use.
- 3 **Add KPIs** with **Add KPI**, fill in each one, then **Save KPIs** (the definition and the KPIs save separately).

✓ GOOD KPIS MAKE BETTER APPRAISALS

Because a role's KPIs are exactly what both the employee and the manager rate at appraisal time, time spent here pays off later. Clear names, a real target and sensible weights turn a vague review into a specific one.

① WHY A BAND MIGHT SHOW A PADLOCK

Salary bands sit behind the separate compensation permission, just like pay on a profile. If you can manage roles but see a padlock on the bands, that's expected: an admin can grant compensation access if you need it.

Departments

/departments

MANAGER

HR

ADMIN

Departments is the list of teams at Legend of Toys, each with a head, an optional parent department, and a live headcount. It's the structure the directory filters by, the dashboard counts by, and that profiles and roles attach to.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	FEEDS
Defining the team structure.	Read; HR adds & edits.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	Directory, dashboard, profiles.

The list

Each row shows the department's name, code, its head, its parent department (if it sits under another), and its current headcount. The headcount updates as people are assigned to or moved off the department on their profiles.

Adding or editing (HR)

- 1 New Department (or the pencil to edit one) opens a small form.
- 2 Set the name (the only required field), and optionally a code, a head (chosen from people), a parent department and a description.
- 3 Use the Active toggle to retire a department without deleting it.
- 4 Save.

① PARENT DEPARTMENT VS REPORTING LINE

The **parent department** nests teams for grouping (for example a Store team under Production). It is not the same as the org chart's reporting lines, which come from each *person's* manager, not from their department. The two can look similar but are set in different places.

✓ SET A HEAD WHERE YOU CAN

Naming a department head keeps the structure legible and gives the org chart and reports a clear owner per team. It's optional, but a department with no head is easy to lose track of.

PART 5

Administration

Who can see and do what in Podium, and the system-wide settings.

Roles & Permissions

/admin/roles

ADMIN

Roles & Permissions is where an admin defines what people can do in Podium. Podium runs its own set of roles, separate from every other LOT system, built from four simple permissions. You create as many named roles as you like from those permissions, then hand them out on the Users screen.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCOPE
Defining Podium access roles.	Act: create & edit roles.	ADMIN	Podium only, not other systems.

The four permissions

PERMISSION	WHAT IT UNLOCKS
View	The directory, org chart and dashboards. The baseline for seeing anyone beyond yourself.
People (HR)	Manage people, departments, roles, documents and org snapshots, and run appraisal cycles.
Compensation	See and edit pay: increments, bonuses and salary bands. Kept separate so it can be granted on its own.
Admin	Manage these roles, assign people to them, and change settings.

Creating a role

- 1 New Role.** Give it a key (a short code like `hr_lead`), a readable label and an optional description.
- 2 Flip on the permissions** it should carry. A role with none of them is a perfectly valid "self-only" role.
- 3 Save,** then assign people to it on the Users screen.

△ ANY HIGHER PERMISSION SWITCHES VIEW ON FOR YOU

If you turn on People, Compensation or Admin, the **View** permission is switched on and locked automatically. That's deliberate: those jobs all need to see people in the first place, so a role can't accidentally be created that locks itself out of the screens it's meant to use.

System roles

Two roles come built in and can't be reshaped: **Admin** (everything) and **Employee** (the empty, self-only default). You can rename their label and description, but not their permissions, and you can't delete them. A handful of ready-made roles (an HR preset, a compensation preset, a people-manager preset) are also provided to copy or use as-is.

PODIUM ROLES DON'T TOUCH OTHER SYSTEMS

Giving someone the HR or Admin role here changes only their People & Performance access. It does **not** change anything they can do in Garage, Redline or any other LOT system; those are governed separately. This isolation is the whole reason Podium has its own roles. A role with people assigned to it also can't be deleted, so reassign first.

Users

/admin/users

ADMIN

Users is where an admin hands out Podium roles. Every LOT person with a login appears in one list; you pick a Podium role for each. Anyone left without a role gets self-only access, which is a real, working level, just their own profile and wins.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	DEFAULT
Assigning a Podium role to each person.	Act: set one role per person.	ADMIN	No role = self-only.

Reading the list

Each row is a person with a login: their name, email, their current Podium role (or "self-only (default)" if none), and a dropdown to change it. A search box up top filters by name, email or role.

Assigning a role

- 1 Find the person with the search box.
- 2 Pick a role from their dropdown. The list is the roles you defined on Roles & Permissions.
- 3 That's it. The change saves immediately. To remove someone's access back to baseline, choose — none (self-only) —.

① ACCOUNTS COME FROM GARAGE; THIS ONLY SETS PEOPLE ACCESS

You don't create logins here; LOT accounts are made in Garage. The Users screen only decides what a person can do in *Podium*. So a brand-new joiner has a login as soon as Garage sets it up, and self-only access in Podium until you give them a wider role.

⚠ ONE PODIUM ROLE PER PERSON

Each person has exactly one Podium role at a time, so picking a new one replaces the old. If someone needs an unusual mix of access, the answer is to define a role with that mix on Roles & Permissions and assign it, rather than trying to stack roles.

✓ **MANAGER ACCESS DOESN'T NEED A ROLE**

Remember that seeing your team comes from the org chart, not from a role here. You don't need to assign anyone a “manager” role for them to see their reports; just make sure people's managers are set on their profiles. Roles here are for the wider tiers: HR, compensation and admin.

Settings

/admin/settings

ADMIN

Settings holds the handful of system-wide switches that change how Podium behaves for everyone: the salary vault, the appraisal eligibility rule, and the shortcuts into the permission screens. It's a short page, but a couple of its switches are consequential.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCOPE
System-wide settings.	Act: a few global toggles.	ADMIN	The whole of Podium.

Salary Vault

This switch decides whether Podium stores **absolute salary figures** at all. While it's **off** (the default), Podium records only increment percentages and one-time bonus amounts; full base-salary and CTC figures are never kept. Turning it on lets those figures be stored and shown to people with compensation access.

⊖ LEAVE THE VAULT OFF UNTIL THE SECURITY LAYER IS LIVE

Company-wide standing pay is the most sensitive data we hold, so the vault is meant to stay off until an extra sign-in wall (a network-level access layer in front of the whole site) is in place. Do not switch it on as a convenience: turning it on early would store full salaries before that protection exists. Until then, percentages and bonuses cover what appraisals need.

Appraisal Eligibility

A single number: the minimum tenure, in days, before someone counts as eligible for an appraisal. It sets the bar that the enrollment screen uses when it works out who's eligible for a cycle. Edit the number and click away to save.

Permissions

A reminder that Podium runs its own permissions, with quick links to **Roles & Permissions** (define roles) and **Users** (assign them). Anyone with no role assigned gets self-only access. See those two chapters for the detail.

① THESE SETTINGS RIPPLE OUTWARD

Unlike a personal preference, a switch here changes Podium for everyone. The eligibility number shapes who's offered in the next cycle; the vault setting changes what every compensation screen will store and show. Change them with that reach in mind.